BASELINE → TREATMENT → FOLLOW-UP

Checks through your pemetrexed treatment

These columns show the order of care, not equal time intervals. Baseline tests and tests before every cycle are distinct. There is no fixed treatment length or scan interval; any additional immunotherapy needs its own monitoring plan.

Check	Before starting / phase change	Each 21-day cycle	Between visits	Benefit and toxicity review	After last pemetrexed
Blood count, kidneys and liver	Baseline full blood count (FBC), renal and liver profile	Repeat before each cycle	Earlier tests if clinically needed	Review recovery and any dose change	Follow unresolved abnormalities
Vitamins and steroids	Confirm folate, last B12 and one steroid schedule	Folate daily; B12 every three cycles; steroid around each dose	Report missed medicines or poor intake	Check adherence and changes to support medicines	Continue folate for 21 days after final dose
Symptoms and medicine interactions	Review prior toxicity and all medicines	Assess interval symptoms before authorising treatment	Urgent contact for illness; check NSAID/aspirin use	Discuss prior reductions, nerve recurrence and daily function	Follow persistent kidney, nerve, blood or other problems
Disease and treatment aim	Confirm maintenance versus second-line indication	Review symptoms and clinical progress	Extra assessment if needed	Scans and tests according to Consultant plan	Agree follow-up or a different treatment plan

The team arranges and reviews tests. This guide shows expected timing; it does not record completed appointments. National Cancer Control Programme (NCCP) 00222 v5 · official regimen · EMA ALIMTA product information and patient leaflet

THE WHOLE TREATMENT JOURNEY

Pemetrexed Monotherapy: treatment and checks

Non-squamous non-small-cell lung cancer (NSCLC) · standalone maintenance or second-line chemotherapy

One pemetrexed infusion on Day 1 of each 21-day cycle. Treatment is planned every three weeks while it is helping and side effects remain acceptable. There is no fixed total number of cycles in this regimen. Scans, symptoms, blood results, your priorities and the oncology review guide continuation, delays, changes or stopping.

Read from left to right. Columns show stages, not equal lengths of time. This is a general plan: no dates or personal information are needed. Your team confirms which steps apply and arranges appointments.

Treatment, tests and reviews across the course

Care / check	Before starting / phase change	Each 21-day cycle	Between visits	Benefit and toxicity review	After last pemetrexed
Treatment course NCCP 00222	Confirm standalone maintenance or second-line	Day 1 pemetrexed; repeat every 21 days if appropriate	Recovery, daily folate and symptom reporting	Continue only while benefit and tolerability remain acceptable	Agree next treatment or follow-up plan

Care / check	Before starting / phase change	Each 21-day cycle	Between visits	Benefit and toxicity review	After last pemetrexed
Blood count, kidneys and liver NCCP 00222	Baseline FBC, renal and liver profile	Repeat before each cycle	Earlier tests if clinically needed	Review recovery and any dose change	Follow unresolved abnormalities
Vitamins and steroids NCCP 00222	Confirm folate, last B12 and one steroid schedule	Folate daily; B12 every three cycles; steroid around each dose	Report missed medicines or poor intake	Check adherence and changes to support medicines	Continue folate for 21 days after final dose
Symptoms and medicine interactions NCCP 00222 · SMPC	Review prior toxicity and all medicines	Assess interval symptoms before authorising treatment	Urgent contact for illness; check NSAID/aspirin use	Discuss prior reductions, nerve recurrence and daily function	Follow persistent kidney, nerve, blood or other problems
Disease and treatment aim NCCP 00222	Confirm maintenance versus second-line indication	Review symptoms and clinical progress	Extra assessment if needed	Scans and tests according to Consultant plan	Agree follow-up or a different treatment plan

What each check is for

1 Vitamin preparation or carry-forward

Before first pemetrexed or a phase change

Vitamins lower serious pemetrexed toxicity.

Ask / act: Confirm last B12 and next due date, daily folate and one steroid prescription.

Sources: NCCP 00222

2 Review each dose

Before every 21-day cycle

Counts, organ function and toxicity can change.

Ask / act: Confirm whether to continue, delay, modify or stop.

Sources: NCCP 00222

3 Benefit review

According to Consultant plan

There is no fixed total cycle number.

Ask / act: Confirm ongoing benefit and the next plan.

Sources: NCCP 00222

4 Final dose follow-up

After the final pemetrexed

Protection and recovery continue after the infusion.

Ask / act: Agree medicine stop dates and review persistent symptoms.

Sources: NCCP 00222

At the next review, ask

- Which treatment phase am I in, and what happens next?
- Which test is expected next, who arranges it, and who explains the result?
- Who should I contact if an expected appointment has not arrived?

This map does not show whether a test has been ordered, booked or completed. Do not wait for a scheduled test if you develop new symptoms.

Sources checked 2026-11-02 · Source reconciled; independent clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending · SACTCheck v0.84.29